

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY AFRICA

Minutes of the CSSR4Africa Team Meeting

Date and Time: 21st April 2026, at 11:00am

Venue: C210

Status: Draft

Participants

Clifford Onyonka

Deogratius Kigudde

Muhirwa Richard

Tsegazeab Tefferi

Yohannes Haile, Chairman

Apologies

Birhanu Shimelis Girma

Lenah Chacha

Moise Busogi

1. Introduction and review of agenda

The chairman, Yohannes Haile, welcomed all the present members to the meeting.

2. Minutes of last meeting and matters arising

The participants reviewed the minutes of the previous meeting held on 14th April 2026 and approved them as a true and accurate record of the meeting.

Agenda item 1: Submit software for quality assurance

Action: Done, All the software has been submitted and the quality assurance has begun.

Agenda item 2: Quality assurance for submitted software.

Action: Ongoing, quality assurance of all software is set to be completed on 24th April 2026.

Agenda item 3: Conduct a Pepper robot tour guide demonstration at the DEC

Action: Not yet done, Deogratius will plan with Yohannes on when to do this demo

3. Matters arising from progress reports

There were no matters arising from the previous progress report.

4. Status of tasks, deliverables and software

The naming convention for the software files of the new updates, which include both ROS actions and services, should include “(1.1)” in their names (e.g.,textToSpeechImplementation1.1) to indicate that they are a new version of the software.

From the team discussion about the localization node, it was suggested that the SLAM-based localization developed by Birhanu should be used. According to Tsegazeab, the last time he tested it, it was working correctly.

5. Status of milestones

It was noted that all focus should now be on the delivering tasks identified in the work plan, due to the nearing of the completion date of the project. Tasks such as conversation management to aid in question answering and writing papers are to be dropped so that the focus be on ensuring that speech event, text to speech, and other tasks within the work plan are complete. Task reallocation should also be done so that all efforts are focused on finalising the project.

6. Any Other Business

Contract extensions

Deogratus mentioned that only Prof Moise has information of whether contract extensions will be given, and that the three names have been submitted to the HR and they haven't responded yet with that regard.

Interview by a Pittsburgh communication team regarding CSSR4Africa

Deogratus mentioned that a team from Pittsburgh will contact us once the project is over, to interview us on the CSSR4Africa project and the interview is expected with CSSR4Africa in May.

CMU Africa research week

Yohannes will be attending the CMU Africa research week and he will be presenting the CSSR4Africa project.

7. Date and time of next meeting

The next meeting will be held on 28th April 2026 at 11:00am in Room C210.

End of the Meeting

There being no other business, the Chairman thanked the participants for their contributions and closed the meeting at 11:20am.

Action items following the meeting of the CSSR4Africa project

Action	Action description	Responsible	Completion date
1	CSSR4Africa Final report first draft	Yohannes	24 April, 2026
2	Remove LLM conversation pipeline from task allocation.	Yohannes	24 April, 2026
3	Conduct a Pepper robot tour guide demonstration at the DEC	Yohannes	TBD

Table 1: action Items